

Market Wrap Up

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Market News

Global equities finished the Wednesday 26 August 2026 session broadly firmer, though gains were modest as investors braced for Nvidia's earnings after the close and digested a sticky US inflation print. Wall Street edged higher: the S&P 500 rose 0.08 per cent to 7,683.14, the Dow Jones Industrial Average added 0.10 per cent to 53,631.11, the Nasdaq Composite gained 0.01 per cent to 26,152.88 and the small-cap Russell 2000 outperformed with a 0.50 per cent gain to 3,010.02. July PCE inflation came in at 3.7 per cent year on year, holding steady and still well above the Fed's 2 per cent target, which kept rate-cut expectations in check; core PCE was expected to hold at 3.3 per cent. In Europe the DAX rose 0.40 per cent to 26,372.24, the CAC 40 gained 0.66 per cent to 8,494.69 and the FTSE 100 added 0.17 per cent to 10,905.02. Across Asia the Nikkei 225 climbed 0.62 per cent to 66,262.16, the Hang Seng rose 0.56 per cent to 25,652.97, the KOSPI jumped 0.97 per cent to 6,808.21 and the Shanghai Composite gained 0.59 per cent to 3,912.52, while India's BSE Sensex eased 0.24 per cent to 77,472.94 and Singapore's Straits Times Index slipped 0.25 per cent to 5,721.59. Brazil's Ibovespa advanced 0.90 per cent to 176,140. Australia's S&P/ASX 200 fell 0.40 per cent to 9,127.8 and the All Ordinaries lost 0.39 per cent to 9,338.8. The main driver was the inflation and earnings backdrop: oil retreated for a third straight session, with Brent easing toward \$85, helping calm inflation fears, while gold slipped about 0.7 per cent to near \$4,624 an ounce after a strong month and bitcoin eased 0.67 per cent to about \$78,376. The dollar was soft after touching a more than three-month low last week. The focus now shifts to Nvidia's results, due after the close on 26 August, with the chip giant - now above a \$5 trillion market value - expected to report roughly \$92 billion in revenue, up about 97 per cent year on year. The rest of the week brings the Kansas City Fed's Jackson Hole symposium on 27-29 August, with Fed Chair Kevin Warsh speaking on Friday 28 August, plus Salesforce and CrowdStrike earnings, second-quarter US GDP, durable goods and consumer confidence, and Tokyo CPI. Into early September, attention turns to the US jobs report and further PCE data as markets weigh how quickly the Fed can ease.

This is a condensed snapshot. The complete edition - exchange rates and bitcoin, world indices, commodities, regional top performers, capital raises and new listings, tech, world news and world sport - is published in full at <https://claude.ai/code/artifact/843fe9ec-75b9-43fe-b1f1-19454a9716c4>. Information only; not investment advice.